

speakers. You get app support, which I honestly don't quite understand. The most you can do from here is enable "Stack Mode" which is their name for the daisy chaining feature, and control bass and treble, that's about it. The bass and treble can be controlled from the speaker itself. The only use of this app is for the Stack Mode.

A few more integrations and a graphic EQ that allows users to customise their sound at a more in-depth level would be a great thing to have in my opinion. Marshall, please fix.

Due to the form factor and the positioning of this speaker, you get an official IP rating for this speaker. The Marshall Middleton has an IP67 rating which means the speaker can withstand a few splashes of water and is fairly resistant to dust. So, unlike other Marshall speakers, you actually do not need to worry about the speaker when you are out and about with it. And, the fact that the speaker has an in-built battery, which doubles up as a power bank as well, makes the case better for Marshall Middleton, which is otherwise, quite low on features.

PERFORMANCE

The part which won the Marshall Middleton the Digit Zero1 Award 2023 in the Best Performing Bluetooth Speakers category — the performance. Marshall aced every test we threw at it. In terms of the sound, the Marshall Middleton boasts a fairly balanced sound signature. The bass, the mids, and the highs, all three fluencies and their sub-frequencies are balanced to the point where I can be confident recommending this speaker to a person who listens to classical music and to someone who is into the much bassier, hip-hop music.

Due to its compact size, the speaker is not able to produce the sub-bass that its bigger cousins were able to produce, or for that matter, some of the competing speakers as well. However, the balanced profile ensures that the speaker is more versatile than the others, and the missing parts of the sub-bass frequencies can be forgiven.



In terms of loudness, the Marshall Middleton put in fairly impressive numbers. The speaker recorded a respectable 86dB of SPL reading, which was the second-lowest of the lot. However, the other speakers were much bigger in terms of their size, and hence were able to provide a much louder sound output. What also amazed me about the speaker was its wide soundstage and excellent layering and separation. If you ever plan on trying this speaker out, I would recommend you use the track - Hotel California - for the test. We use the track here at the Test Centre, and everyone was surprised as to how well this speaker was able to separate the different frequencies that are present in the track. And, be it gaming or movie watching, there was no noticeable lag that I experienced with this speaker.

BATTERY LIFE

The part where this speaker overtook the otherwise equally matched — Devialet Mania, was the battery life. The Marshall Middleton comes with a claimed battery life of over 20 hours. In my setting, the speaker lasted around seven and a half hours. Now, this is much less than what is advertised. And, your settings while using the speaker will definitely make a difference in this number.

The speaker has a USB-C port for charging. The same port can be used for charging and providing a power output as well, in case you need a power bank at hand in a crunch situation. If you want to make the most of the speaker's battery, then you can also connect to the

speaker using the 3.5mm audio jack that has been provided on the speaker, right next to the charging port.

VERDICT

The last word on the Marshall Middleton from me is — the speaker screams quality and makes for a great buy if you are looking for the best listening experience. The speaker won the Digit Zero1 Award 2023, in the Best Performing Bluetooth Speakers category for a reason. It provides great sound, at a fair price and ensures that regardless of the genre that you are listening to, you are in for a treat.

However, if you are looking for a feature-rich alternative to the Marshall Middleton, then I would say, you can look at the Sony SRS-XE300, which launched last year, or the JBL Charge 5. Both these speakers are packed with features and come with a sound signature out of the box, which in my experience would be great for almost everyone who is into a slightly bass-demanding genre of content or music.

—Sativik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

DRIVER TYPE: Dynamic | FREQUENCY RANGE: 50 Hz-20,000 Hz | DRIVERS: Two 3" 15W woofers, Two 3/5" 10W tweeters, Two passive radiators | MAXIMUM SOUND PRESSURE LEVEL: 87 dB SPL @ 1 m | PLAY TIME: 20+ hours | QUICK CHARGING: 20 minutes charge gives 2 hours of playtime | CHARGING TIME: 4.5 hours | DIMENSIONS: 109 x 230 x 95 mm | WEIGHT: 1.8 kg | WATER RESISTANCE: IP67

CONTACT

Phone: +91 97161 46370 | Email: support@luxurypersonified.co.in | Website: <https://www.marshallheadphones.com/in/en/>